

Gulf Coast weather briefing

Oct 7, 6:15 a.m. CDT / 7:15 a.m. EDT

Tropical Storm Isaias

Friday hurricane risk. Prioritize the western Panhandle.

TL;DR

- Timing

Prepare Thursday for Friday impacts. StormGeo’s Florida 25+ mph windows begin around 8–9:40 a.m. CDT Friday.
- Priority

Pensacola, Gulf Breeze and Navarre have the strongest supplied point winds and 6–10 inches of private-scenario rainfall.
- Track

NHC track confidence is below average. A change in the northward turn can move the strongest wind and rain corridor.

Cyclone peak sustained wind

100 / 110 mph

StormGeo / NHC · over the Gulf, not at a site

Western Panhandle point gusts

69–74 mph

Navarre / Gulf Breeze / Pensacola

Main impact day

Friday

Complete readiness Thursday, ahead of Friday’s winds

What changed since October 6

- Earlier: Friday approach replaces Saturday.
- Stronger: hurricane forecast over the Gulf.
- Farther east: western Panhandle becomes the higher priority.

STORMGEO CITY POINT	UPPER SUSTAINED (MPH)	GUST (MPH)	PROBABILITY ≥39 MPH	RAIN (IN)
New Orleans	26	46	28%	2–5
Panama City	35	49	41%	3–6
Navarre	51	69	60%	6–10
Gulf Breeze	53	73	58%	6–10
Pensacola	56	74	62%	6–10

Next update: Refresh after StormGeo’s 9 a.m. CDT full advisory or any earlier official watch or material track change.

Planning timeline

Now · Wed Oct 7

Activate readiness review

Verify site contacts, continuity plans and response priorities.

Fri Oct 9

Manage impacts

Florida winds morning; New Orleans afternoon. Monitor tornado alerts.

Thu Oct 8

Complete preparations

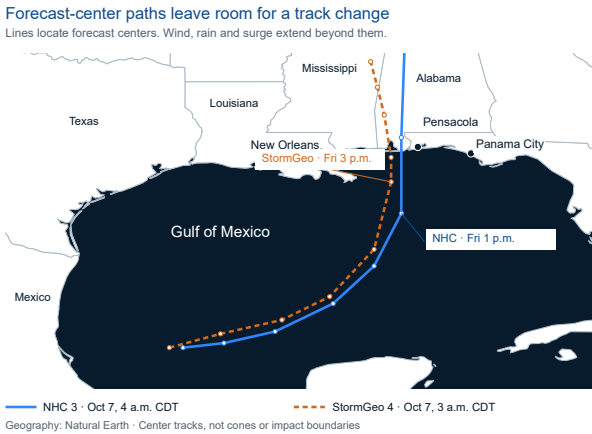
Recommended target; rain may precede the main wind windows.

Sat–Sun Oct 10–11

Verify recovery access

Verify access; StormWatch regional window extends through Sunday morning.

Where the exposure sits



NHC Advisory 3 (4 a.m. CDT) and StormGeo Advisory 4 (3 a.m. CDT), Oct 7. The later private 4a eastward shift is qualitative and not drawn.

Natural Earth · NWS Mobile · NWS Tallahassee

Peak gusts by forecast point

Friday Oct 9–Saturday Oct 10 · gusts, not sustained wind

Pensacola	74 mph
25+ mph: Fri 7:54 a.m. – Sat 5:04 a.m. CDT	
Gulf Breeze	73 mph
25+ mph: Fri 7:59 a.m. – Sat 5:00 a.m. CDT	
Navarre	69 mph
25+ mph: Fri 8:14 a.m. – Sat 4:44 a.m. CDT	
Panama City	49 mph
25+ mph: Fri 9:37 a.m. – Sat 2:01 a.m. CDT	
New Orleans	46 mph
25+ mph: Fri 12:55 p.m. – Fri 6:50 p.m. CDT	

StormGeo Advisory 4 point forecasts · peak gusts during passage. Wind periods vary by point; values are not hurricane categories.

Official and private forecasts

QUESTION	NOAA / NHC / NWS	STORMGEO	OPERATIONAL MEANING
Cyclone strength	NHC peak: 110 mph sustained	StormGeo peak: 100 mph sustained	Both forecast hurricane strength; these are core winds, not city winds.
Track / rain corridor	NHC: east shift, below-average track confidence	4a: shift east of Mobile Bay next full cycle	Keep readiness flexible on both sides of the forecast center.
Wind odds ≥39 mph	NHC: NOLA 11% · Pensacola 56% · Panama City 45%	StormGeo: 28% · 62% · 41%	Different point definitions and windows; do not average.

Plan for three outcomes

Current eastern corridor

Highest current supplied point concern: western Florida Panhandle.

Response: Prioritize wind, rain, coastal access and backup-power readiness.

Track shifts west / east

Strongest effects move with the center and asymmetric bands.

Response: Reorder site priorities each cycle; center lines are not impact boundaries.

Worst credible disruption

Stronger winds combine with flooding, outages and blocked access near landfall.

Response: Plan for loss of multiple services; no invented odds, depths or outage duration.

Decisions to make now

All sites	Review SOPs, critical processes and tested backup arrangements by Thursday.
Western Panhandle	Prioritize exterior protection, water mitigation and coastal-access contingencies.
New Orleans	Use the Hilton brief; check local winds, rain and access.
Operations / NorthStar	Align escalation contacts, response priorities and damage documentation.

NorthStar can support readiness and recovery. Pre-loss planning · Water mitigation · Structural drying · Facility support

Call 800.283.2933

Sources and forecast basis

- 1

StormGeo
Private scenario · Primary private scenario
Oct 7: full/site 4 and StormWatch 3 a.m. CDT; 4a 4 a.m. No refreshed site tables.
- 2

NOAA / NHC
Official status and warnings · Controlling
Advisory 3: Oct 7, 4 a.m. CDT. No coastal watches/warnings then.
[Forecast](#) · [Discussion](#) · [Wind probabilities](#)
- 3

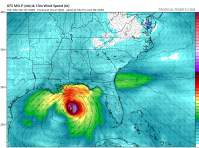
NWS New Orleans
Local official guidance · High planning value
Oct 7: vicinity grid 5:21 a.m. CDT; discussion 4:22 a.m. Not rooftop wind.
[Local discussion](#)
- 4

NOAA / WPC
Regional rainfall risk · High planning value
Issued Oct 7, 5:03 a.m. EDT; valid Fri 7 a.m.–Sat 7 a.m. CDT.
- 5

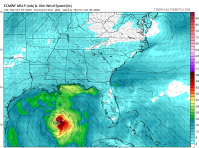
Tropical Tidbits
Comparable model snapshots · Supporting
Oct 7 runs: supporting model guidance; no blended forecast or calibrated scenario odds.

Model guidance

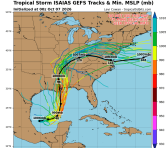
TropicalTidbits.com · model guidance, not an official forecast. Wind panels share Fri 1 p.m. CDT valid time; initializations differ. Ensemble lines are not odds.



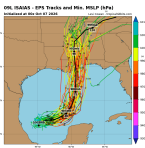
GFS
06Z Oct 7 · +60h · Fri 1 p.m. CDT. Faster / farther northeast.
[TropicalTidbits.com source](#)



ECMWF
00Z Oct 7 · +66h · Fri 1 p.m. CDT. Slower / farther southwest.
[TropicalTidbits.com source](#)



GEFS ensemble tracks
00Z Oct 7 · plotted forecast tracks. Lines and colors are not probabilities.
[TropicalTidbits.com source](#)



ECMWF EPS ensemble tracks
00Z Oct 7 · plotted forecast tracks. Lines and colors are not probabilities.
[TropicalTidbits.com source](#)

Read the limits

- StormGeo points are not verified properties. Wind ranges are maximum likely hourly observations; gusts differ from sustained wind.
- Probabilities use different points/windows: StormGeo passage; NHC five-day one-minute sustained wind. No averaging.
- Private rain totals lack an explicit period; coastal-water values lack a datum. No hotel flood depth is established.
- StormWatch regional window: Fri 6 a.m.–Sun 6 a.m. CDT. Tornado-band window: Fri 4 p.m.–Sat 7 p.m.; mainly near/east of center. Dated briefing.